Flourish
LEGAL WELL-BEING

Working Mindfully with Emotions

When we feel emotional discomfort, our instinct is to try and get rid of it.

Not only is that impossible, it's counterproductive.

If we just stop trying to "solve" our emotions, we can find real relief, even in the midst of them.

When you have that nagging feeling of emotional discomfort, remember "NAG":

N

NOTICE the presence of discomfort.

Ask yourself: are you feeling any emotional discomfort right now?

Once you've spotted the discomfort, you're less likely to react to it unconsciously.

A

ACCEPT your experience, including the discomfort.

Adopt an attitude of nonchalance toward the emotional discomfort, rather than a need to get rid of it.

Try saying to yourself: "Right now, it's like this."

G

GROUND your attention in the body.

Use one of these methods:

- Bring attention to your belly, feeling its rise and fall as you breathe.
- Feel your feet on the ground, bringing attention to the sensation of contact.
- If you're sitting, bring attention to the sensation of contact with the chair.

With gratitude to Ajahn Sumedho, who coined the phrase, "Right now, it's like this."